The 6:15

TUESDAY · NOVEMBER 3, 2026 NO. 35

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Tue 11/3 (today)	Midterm elections — all 435 House seats, 35 Senate seats (13 D, 22 R) up; polls close 6p–1a ET by state. JOLTS (Sept.) 10:00a ET. Pfizer reports before the open; AMD after close, 5p ET call. OPEC+'s Nov. 1 meeting outcome still not published **[flag, carried from No. 34]**.
Thu 11/5	Election results likely still being finalized in close races — PA, MI, WI historically slower counts (AP/NBC).
Fri 11/6	October jobs report (NFP), 8:30a ET.
Mon 11/9	Veterans Day observed — equities open, bond market closed.
Tue 11/10	October CPI, 8:30a ET.
Fri 11/13	October PPI, 8:30a ET.

No FOMC meeting this window — Fed holds 3.50%–3.75% from Oct. 28; next decision Dec. 9. No frontier AI release, major rocket launch, or large VC round confirmed this run — omitted rather than padded.

METRICS · ~5:20A ET UNLESS NOTED

Mon. 11/2 close	S&P 500 -0.51%; Nasdaq Comp. -1.07%; Dow +0.41% (~+214 pts) — Yahoo Finance; index levels not independently confirmed **[flag]**.
Futures, premarket Tue.	Dow -0.5% to -0.55%; S&P 500 -0.1% to -0.2%; Nasdaq-100 +0.1% to +0.24% — mixed, sources vary.
Brent / WTI	Brent $105.03 Mon. settle (-7.4%, steepest drop in 2+ months) on Iran de-escalation hopes; WTI ~$96–97 Mon. Tue. retrace unsettled: quotes range $105–$109 **[flag, diverging]**. Spread ~$8–9.
2Y / 10Y / 30Y	4.59% / 4.91% / 5.28% — CNBC, Tue. intraday ~5a ET; not yet a settle.

DXY	~101.8 — Mon. close cited; Tue. level not independently confirmed **[flag]**.
VIX	21.27 Mon. close (+0.57%) — a conflicting same-day Tue. reading (21.15) doesn't reconcile **[flag]**.
Gold	$3,917.40 Mon. close (-1.31%) — conflicting Tue. reads (+1.9% vs. -1%) not reconciled **[flag]**.
Asia / Europe	Kospi -3.59%; Kosdaq -4.08%; Taiwan Wtd. -3.59%; CSI 300 -0.2%; ASX 200 +0.34%; Hang Seng +0.37%; Japan closed (holiday). Stoxx 600 -0.62% at Tue. open.
Retail gas (AAA natl. avg.)	$4.1493/gal (11/3), down from $4.1837 (10/31) — decline continues.

Monday's 7.4% Brent plunge priced in a Hormuz de-escalation that the overnight US strikes now complicate — see Lead.

HORMUZ COUNTERS — STRAITS.LIVE, 03 NOV 10:17Z (5:17A ET)

Status	Closed to commercial shipping since Feb. 28 — Day 247 by this brief's count.
Transits	Still 2 vessels on Oct. 25 (PortWatch) vs. 85/day baseline (2%) — unrevised, 9 days stale. 30-day median: 3.5/day. 146 vessels concurrently AIS-tracked in zone (different measure).
Dark tankers, 24h	163/236 screened (69.1%) — up sharply from Sun.'s 40.8% **[NEW, flag]**; non-tanker ambient dropout 37.7%, a wider gap than recent days.
War-risk premium	~32x pre-crisis; VLCC $250K–$10M — flagged stale to Jul. 27, older than the Oct. 7 vintage carried as recently as yesterday **[flag, unresolved]**.
Indices	Crisis Pressure 88±9 (Extreme; inputs stale to Oct. 25); Escalation Forecast 59±11 (Elevated; flat vs. yesterday).
Market odds (Polymarket/Kalshi)	Blockade ends by Dec. 31: 40.05%. Traffic normal by Nov. 30: 5.5%; not normal all of 2026: 89%. US invades Iran before 2027: 17.5%.

PortWatch undercounts true flow; the dark-tanker screen measures AIS silence, not interdiction, and today's jump is one 24h read, not a trend; the war-risk figure is a stale single trade-press estimate. None of the three is additive — straits.live's "closed" verdict is a composite judgment, not an average.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Bednar qualifying-offer decision still pending, not confirmed **[flag, continuity]**.
Knicks	Beat Brooklyn 103-90 Mon. at MSG — now 3-4 **[NEW, resolves prior record discrepancy]**.
Northwestern	No reported moves; next opponent not confirmed this run.

LEAD

MARKETS / ELECTION DAY

Hours before the midterms, the US strikes Iranian targets in the Strait — breaking Trump's own no-war-before-the-election pledge

Just after Monday's close, multiple US officials told the Wall Street Journal, CBS News and the AP that American forces had carried out "defensive" strikes on Iranian targets near the Strait of Hormuz, reportedly hitting Qeshm Island in southern Iran. [fact, NEW] The stated trigger: Iran's Revolutionary Guard Corps fired on a US aircraft. Officials gave no casualty or damage figures, and the strikes were not announced publicly — they surfaced through reporting, not a Pentagon statement. [fact, NEW] The timing is the story as much as the act: Trump had told voters repeatedly in the campaign's final stretch that he would not strike Iran before the midterms, arguing "it's not a war" because there had been no sustained fighting for months. Fox News reported the strikes did not mark the start of an expanded campaign, and Trump himself posted Monday that a deal with Tehran "could happen," with Iran "want[ing] a settlement, as soon as possible." [fact, NEW] Those two facts — a defensive strike authorized and a settlement framed as imminent — sat in the news cycle at the same time, hours before polls opened.

The market had already made its bet on de-escalation, and the strikes land squarely against it. Brent fell 7.4% Monday to $105.03, its sharpest one-day drop in more than two months, on reporting that mediators — Qatar and Pakistan among them — were close to a framework in which Iran halts attacks on shipping and the US lifts its naval blockade of Iranian ports. [fact, NEW] That rally in oil-as-relief now has to clear the Monday-night strikes before Tuesday's session, and the signals are already mixed: one overnight quote had Brent retracing to roughly $105, another put it near $109, a spread wide enough that this brief isn't printing a single Tuesday figure (see Board). [fact/flag] The mechanism for an investor: a Hormuz premium that traders had started pricing out on Monday affects every downstream input — jet fuel, diesel, the retail gas string that's fallen for weeks running — and a re-escalation, even a contained one, reinserts the tail risk that justified the premium in the first place. Second-order: Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu is reportedly pressing Washington for a broader air campaign once the midterms are over, and Trump has said he's in "no rush" to decide — which means the strike-and-settle signals sent Monday night may be a floor, not a ceiling, on what comes next. [read]

The election itself is the other half of tonight's mechanism. Polls close in a rolling sequence from 6p ET (parts of Indiana/Kentucky) through 1a ET (Alaska); Pennsylvania, Michigan and Wisconsin are flagged by AP and NBC as historically slow counters, so close races there may not be called Tuesday night. [fact, NEW] Democrats enter with a mid-to-high-single-digit generic-ballot lead in this brief's running read — PollCheck's aggregate stood at D+8.7 (51.1%-42.4%) as of Oct. 27, with a Reuters/Ipsos likely-voter sample at 53%-44% (Oct. 26) — against a Trump approval rating Reuters/Ipsos sepa-

rately put at 32%, up slightly off a cycle low but still historically weak this close to a midterm. [fact, continuity] No independently confirmed aggregate update landed in this run past Oct. 27; this brief isn't printing a newer composite number it can't source cleanly. North Carolina and Georgia's Senate races remain the top Democratic targets per pre-election coverage, with Georgia incumbent Jon Ossoff seen as well positioned; Republicans hold the Senate 53-47 and the House by single digits entering the night. [fact, continuity]

Read: an administration that just authorized a strike it had promised to withhold, hours before voters who've spent a year watching gasoline prices move with the Hormuz crisis go to the polls, is a split-screen Washington will be arguing about by Wednesday regardless of the vote count — did the strike leak because it was meant to project strength, or because it couldn't be contained until polls closed. For the investor reader, Tuesday's actual tradable variable isn't who wins the House margin-of-a-few-seats question; it's whether divided government (a Democratic House against any Senate outcome) revives 2027 fiscal brinkmanship as the default posture, and whether a contained strike-then-settle pattern holds or gives way to the "one or two more targets" Trump flagged over the weekend, including the suspected Pickaxe Mountain nuclear complex. [read] Watch: poll closes starting 6p ET; any Pentagon confirmation or denial of the Qeshm strikes; Iran's response, if any, through Tuesday; and whether Brent's Tuesday session settles nearer Monday's post-drop level or claws back toward last week's highs.

POLITICS

Beyond the Lead's framing, the mechanical calendar matters for an investor reader: expect the earliest calls (Georgia, Virginia, South

Carolina at 7p ET) within an hour or two of poll close, while Pennsylvania, Michigan and Wisconsin — three of the cycle's most contested Senate and House battlegrounds — are explicitly flagged as likely to run past Tuesday night. [fact, NEW] Prediction markets, last read ahead of this run, had Democrats heavily favored for the House (Kalshi ~92%, Polymarket ~92.5%, as of late September per secondary aggregation — not reconfirmed intraday today **[flag]**) with the Senate closer to even-money; a Democratic sweep priced around 52.5% against a Republican sweep near 12.5% on the same stale read. [fact/flag, continuity] This brief flagged in issue No. 34 the gap between model-based forecasts (94.7% House, 62.1% Senate for Democrats) and market pricing — that gap is the thing to watch close tonight, not the headline median forecast. [read, continuity] The fabricated-polling episode (Wedgewood Polls, exposed Oct. 20) remains unresolved reputationally; no tracker has published a further retraction or correction in this run. [fact, continuity]

ECONOMICS

JOLTS data for September is due 10:00a ET today — a labor-demand read that arrives the same morning as the election and, this cycle, carries extra weight given how thin recent jobs data has been. Friday brings the October jobs report itself at 8:30a ET; this brief could not verify a consensus forecast this run and won't print one it can't source. **[flag]** There is no FOMC meeting in this window: the Fed held its target at 3.50%-3.75% on Oct. 28 and doesn't meet again until Dec. 9, so Tuesday and Friday's data effectively set up that decision without an intervening Fed reaction. CPI (Oct.) follows Nov. 10, PPI Nov. 13. Retail gas extended its decline to $4.1493/gal nationally (11/3), continuing a weeks-long slide that predates Monday

night's strikes — worth tracking for whether the retreat holds once Tuesday's crude price actually settles. [fact, NEW]

BUSINESS

Apple's fiscal Q4 (reported Monday, its first call with John Ternus as CEO) posted record September-quarter revenue of $114.5 billion, up 12% year over year and above the company's own $111.69-113.74 billion guided range, with diluted EPS of $2.10 (+14% y/y, including a $0.05 tariff-refund benefit) and gross margin of 47.9%. [fact, NEW] Services hit an all-time high and iPhone posted a September-quarter record; CFO Kevan Parekh said the quarter capped a full fiscal year of $479 billion in revenue. [fact, NEW] Pfizer was scheduled to report before Tuesday's open and AMD after Tuesday's close (5p ET call) — consensus for Pfizer clustered near $0.72-0.77 EPS on roughly $15.9-16.1 billion revenue, and for AMD near $13.06 billion revenue (+41% y/y) — but neither company's actual print surfaced in this run's research in time for press; both are flagged not verified as of press time rather than estimated. **[flag, NEW]**

TECHNOLOGY

The overnight Asia session carried a visible chip-stock mark: Kospi -3.59%, Kosdaq -4.08% and Taiwan's Weighted Index -3.59%, all markets heavy with AMD/Nvidia supply-chain exposure, in what reads as pre-positioning ahead of AMD's after-the-close print and lingering nerves from Intel's historic Oct. 30 crash (its worst single session since 1974, this brief's issue No. 33). [fact/read, NEW] That selloff didn't extend evenly — Hong Kong and Australia both traded higher the same session — which argues against a single unifying narrative and for stock- and sector-specific positioning into a results-

heavy week. [read] No frontier AI model release, funding round, or rocket launch cleared this brief's verification bar this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the Lead and Board: Qatar and Pakistan are mediating a framework under which Iran would stop targeting shipping in the strait in exchange for the US lifting its naval blockade of Iranian ports; Iran's own proposal, per AP sourcing, goes further — frozen-asset release, sanctions relief and a halt to hostilities on all fronts, in exchange for reopening Hormuz and returning to nuclear talks, with a two-day implementation window offered. [fact, continuity] Foreign Minister Araghchi said talks are "proceeding very intensively" but warned of a "stronger response" if the US launches further military operations; a foreign ministry spokesperson put it more bluntly — "the ball is in the US court." [fact, NEW] Iran's First Vice President characterized the US messaging as an implicit acknowledgment of Tehran's "victory," while the supreme leader warned of no "geographical limitations" should fighting resume — rhetoric this brief carries as attributed claims, not independently verified fact. **[fact/flag, NEW]** Iranian state media's claim of 11 tankers catching fire near the strait over nine days, and a separate claim that a tanker struck a mine, both remain uncorroborated by UKMTO, CENTCOM or any flag state; the US military has denied the mine claims and says it has cleared the relevant routes. **[fact/flag, continuity]** The dark-tanker jump to 69.1% (see Board) is this run's one hard anomaly — whether it reflects genuine evasion tied to Monday night's strikes or another ambient-dropout episode isn't resolvable from this run's data alone.

SPORTS

Yankees	Season over (eliminated Oct. 7, ALDS). Bednar qualifying-offer decision still pending, not confirmed.

Knicks	3-4 after beating Brooklyn 103-90 Monday — Shamet's 22 off the bench led a 25-5 fourth-quarter run; Brooklyn falls to 1-6.
Northwestern	Lost 34-14 at No. 4 Oregon Saturday (first-ever meeting); next game not confirmed this run.

Continuity. Geopolitics is cut as a standalone section this issue — the Qeshm strikes and the US-Iran diplomatic track are this week's whole geopolitical story, and they're covered in the Lead and Iran & Hormuz. Knicks' record is resolved (3-4) after weeks of source conflict.

Unverified figures flagged this issue: Monday's exact index closing levels (percentage moves only, confirmed); Tuesday's Brent/WTI, DXY, VIX and gold levels (sources diverge or conflict with Monday's confirmed closes); OPEC+'s Nov. 1 output decision; Pfizer's and AMD's actual Q3 results (scheduled today, not yet reported in this run); Northwestern's next opponent; the Bednar qualifying-offer decision; Iran's claims of 11 tanker fires and a mine strike (state-media sourced, uncorroborated). Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.